

Quack! YbliwybliB, let's turn those resources into a **Policy Audit Checklist** you can use to extract the key data from your Evidence of Coverage (EOC) and other documents. I'll give you a concise, actionable list that aligns with the public sources we just compiled.

## ## Policy Audit Checklist – Pennsylvania Health Insurance

| Section | What to Look For | Where to Verify (Public Source) | Quick-Check Tips |

|---|---|---|---|

| **\*\*1. Coverage Basics\*\*** | • Effective date & renewal schedule <br>• Plan type (HMO, PPO, EPO, HDHP) | • EOC front matter <br>• PID “Form Filings” | Highlight the first three pages; note any “retroactive” clauses. |

| **\*\*2. Cost-Sharing\*\*** | • Copay amounts per service tier <br>• Coinsurance percentages <br>• Out-of-pocket maximum (individual & family) | • SBC (CMS template) <br>• PID “Rate Filings” | Put numbers in a spreadsheet for quick comparison across plans. |

| **\*\*3. Prior Authorization (PA)\*\*** | • Services requiring PA <br>• Timeframe for insurer response <br>• Appeal process for denied PA | • EOC “Prior Authorization” chapter <br>• PID “Regulatory Bulletins” | Flag any “clinical criteria” that could affect your chronic conditions. |

| **\*\*4. Step Therapy / Formulary\*\*** | • Tier placement of each medication <br>• Required step-therapy sequences <br>• Mail-order vs. retail cost differentials | • Pharmacy Formulary (plan portal) <br>• Open Payments (to spot manufacturer-driven tier shifts) | Create a table: medication → tier → 30-day cost vs. 90-day cost. |

| **\*\*5. Network & Out-of-Network\*\*** | • In-network provider list <br>• Out-of-network reimbursement rates <br>• “No Surprises” protections | • PID “Consumer Complaints” (look for network-related issues) <br>• NAIC consumer guides | Verify that your primary care doctor and specialists are listed. |

| **\*\*6. Preventive & Wellness Benefits\*\*** | • Covered screenings, vaccines, annual exams <br>• Free case-management or nurse-coordination services | • EOC “Preventive Services” section <br>• PHAN resources (state-specific programs) | Mark any services you're eligible for but not using. |

| **\*\*7. Appeals & Dispute Process\*\*** | • Timeline for internal appeal, external review, and CMS grievance <br>• Required documentation (e.g., medical records, letters) | • EOC “Appeals” chapter <br>• NAIC “Appeals Guide” | Draft a template letter now; plug in specifics later. |

| **\*\*8. Financial Transparency\*\*** | • Rate filing history (premium changes) <br>• Financial solvency ratios of insurer | • PID “Financial Statements” <br>• NAIC “Financial Data” | Look for any red-flag trends (e.g., rising premiums without benefit changes). |

| **\*\*9. Legal & Regulatory Compliance\*\*** | • Alignment with Pennsylvania statutes (e.g., “No Surprises Act”) <br>• Federal ACA requirements | • Pennsylvania Code (search “health insurance”) <br>• CFR Title 42 (Health) | Cross-check clause numbers; note any deviations. |

| **\*\*10. Data-Retention & Security\*\*** | • How long the insurer keeps EOBs, claims data <br>• Your right to request copies | • EOC “Records Retention” clause <br>• PID consumer rights page | Ensure you have a personal backup strategy. |

## ### How to Use the Checklist

1. **Print or copy** the table into a spreadsheet.
2. **Mark each item** as “Found,” “Missing,” or “Needs Clarification.”
3. **Add notes** with page numbers or URLs for quick reference.
4. **Prioritize** any “Missing” or “Needs Clarification” items for follow-up with your insurer or a consumer-advocacy group.

### ### Quick-Start Prototype (24 h)

1. **Gather** your EOC, SBC, and formulary PDFs.
2. **Run OCR** (e.g., using Tesseract) to make them searchable.
3. **Copy the table** above into Google Sheets or Excel.
4. **Search** each PDF for the keywords in the “What to Look For” column and fill in the spreadsheet.
5. **Save** the sheet as “PA\_Health\_Insurance\_Audit.xlsx” and share it with a trusted advisor for a quick review.

```
```bash
# Example: OCR with Tesseract (Linux/macOS)
sudo apt-get install tesseract-ocr # Debian/Ubuntu
brew install tesseract             # macOS
```

```
# Convert PDF to images then OCR
for pdf in *.pdf; do
  pdftoppm -png "$pdf" "${pdf%.*}"
  for img in "${pdf%.*}*.png; do
    tesseract "$img" "${img%.*}" -l eng
  done
done
```
```

**Tip:** Keep the OCR output in a folder named `ocr\_output/` and link each text file back to its source PDF for traceability.

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